

In This CORNER by bill hodge



The Face Is Familiar

AN OLD FRIEND of the grandstand "needlers" in Lawrence Stadium returns to our town Friday night in the same role in which he first appeared here seven years ago—as manager of the Denver Bears.

The old favorite of the grandstand hecklers, of course, is Andy Cohen who took his share of jibes last season in a most unfamiliar role as skipper of the Indianapolis Indians.

Cohen returned to the helm of the Bears last winter when the New York Yankees called up Ralph Houk to coach with the parent club.

Denver jumped at the chance to rehired Cohen and Cohen jumped at the chance to return to Denver because the Bears and Cohen have made beautiful music together in years gone by.



COHEN

Pinch-hit for Frisch

THIS FELLOW COHEN, by the way, has an interesting background. He's known to the fans here as a manager but he also once played the game.

He started playing baseball back in 1925 when Waco, Tex., was in the Texas League.

It was Cohen's misfortune to be a second baseman at a time when there were many great ones around.

But in 1926 he finally made the New York Giants as a pinch-hitter, an occasion he still refers to as one of his most thrilling moments in baseball.

He pinch-hit for Hall-of-Famer Frankie Frisch, and got a single.

Two years later came his biggest thrill. On opening day, 1928, Cohen succeeded the great Rogers Hornsby on second base with the Giants.

He played in 236 games for New York in the next two campaigns and then returned to the minors where he played through the 1941 season.

Pennant at Denver

COHEN WON A Western League pennant for Denver in

Upsets Aussies

1954, the Bears' last season in the class-A loop, from which Wichita too later was to move into the triple-A American Association.

At the time Denver was getting its players from the Pittsburgh Pirates' chain and he had a fellow playing first base for him who just finished a series here Thursday night as an Omaha Cardinal.

Cohen's first baseman in 1954 at Denver was Pidge Browne, the fellow who was over there on the bag for Omaha the past three nights as the Cards swept an opening series from Wichita.

Cohen and his Denver club, of course, are coming to town with hopes of duplicating the Cardinals' trick—only this time for four games.

On paper the Bears appear a little weaker than last year when they started slowly but came on to win the post-season playoffs and the Junior World Series.

The Bears have lost fellows like Fritzie Brickell on shortstop, Norm Siebern in centerfield, Marv Throneberry on first base and Ryne Durren on the mound.

But they are catching the Braves at their most uneasy moment since last year's minor league manager of the year Ben Geraghty took them over in the spring of a year ago.

So you just can't guess right now how this upcoming Wichita-Denver series will go.

Win or lose, though, the first base grandstand hecklers will have their innings Friday, Saturday and Sunday nights.

An Old Scout Passes

OUR ATTENTION HAS been called to the recent death of Jack Ryan, the former St. Louis Cardinal, Brooklyn Dodger and New York Yankee scout.

Ryan, who became a familiar figure around Wichita during the early and middle years of the National Baseball Congress Tournaments in Lawrence Stadium, succumbed in St. Louis, Mo., the other day.

"Ryan was the best judge of a pitcher I ever saw," said Ed Chaney, president of the Oldtime Ballplayers Association.

Ryan retired several years ago. He would have been 80 years old next June.

One of his prize baseball discoveries was Paul Derringer, pitching ace of the Cincinnati Redlegs' last World Series team, in 1940.